

Argentina vs England

Statistical projection — the match has not been played yet

A hybrid Poisson + Elo model projects the outcome — 60% weight on expected goals, 40% on rating gap, both built from 49,505 real historical matches.

Argentina favored, 47% to win

OUTCOME		PROBABILITY
	Argentina win	47.0%
	Draw	28.3%
	England win	24.7%

Most likely scoreline: 1-0 (17.1%). This is a probabilistic projection generated ahead of kickoff, not a report of an actual result.

Two submodels, blended

Poisson · 60% weight

Each team's attack and defense strength (from a rolling 5-year window) sets an expected-goals rate (λ). Scorelines from 0-0 to 10-10 are modeled as independent Poisson draws, then summed into win/draw/loss shares.

Elo · 40% weight

Ratings start at 1500 and update after all 49,505 historical matches ($K = 32$, goal-difference weighted). The rating gap converts to win/draw/loss odds via the Davidson tie-adjusted model.

Blended = $0.6 \times \text{Poisson} + 0.4 \times \text{Elo}$, renormalized to sum to 100%. Both submodels already include this tournament's real results through the quarterfinal round; the semifinal itself is excluded as unplayed.

The rating gap favors Argentina

	TEAM	CURRENT ELO	DAVIDSON RESULT
	Argentina	2144.4	50.4% win
	Draw	—	24.3%
	England	2025.1	25.3% win

The Davidson (1970) extension adds a draw parameter $v = 0.68$, calibrated by maximum likelihood against all 49,505 historical results. No home-advantage bonus applies — the semifinal is a neutral venue.

Argentina's defense is the edge

Attack & defense strength

Argentina: 1.667 attack / 0.336 defense.

England: 1.659 attack / 0.505 defense.

(1.0 = league average; below 1.0 on defense means fewer goals conceded.)

Expected goals (λ)

Argentina 1.145 · England 0.756 — no home-advantage term, since the venue is neutral. Top scorelines: 1-0 (17.1%), 0-0 (14.9%), 1-1 (12.9%).

Poisson result: Argentina win 44.8%, draw 31.0%, England win 24.2% — over a rolling 5-year window of 68 (Argentina) and 67 (England) matches.

47.0% Argentina, but treat as a range

	OUTCOME	POISSON (60%)	ELO (40%)	BLENDED
■	Argentina win	44.8%	50.4%	47.0%
■	Draw	31.0%	24.3%	28.3%
■	England win	24.2%	25.3%	24.7%

Caveats: attack/defense ratios aren't opponent-adjusted (strength-of-schedule bias); goals are modeled as independent, ignoring low-scoring correlation; no injury, suspension or lineup data is included. Head-to-head (3 Argentina wins, 6 draws, 6 England wins in 15 meetings) is shown for context only and doesn't feed the model.